

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 26, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 15:16-29

16 Then David spoke to the leaders of the Levites to appoint their brethren to be the singers accompanied by instruments of music, stringed instruments, harps, and cymbals, by raising the voice with resounding joy.

17 So the Levites appointed Heman the son of Joel; and of his brethren, Asaph the son of Berechiah; and of their brethren, the sons of Merari, Ethan the son of Kushaiah;

18 and with them their brethren of the second rank: Zechariah, Ben, Jaaziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattithiah, Elipheleh, Mikneiah, Obed-Edom, and Jeiel, the gatekeepers;

19 the singers, Heman, Asaph, and Ethan, were to sound the cymbals of bronze;

20 Zechariah, Aziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Maaseiah, and Benaiah, with strings according to Alamoth;

21 Mattithiah, Elipheleh, Mikneiah, Obed-Edom, Jeiel, and Azaziah, to direct with harps on the Sheminith;

22 Chenaniah, leader of the Levites, was instructor in charge of the music, because he was skillful;

23 Berechiah and Elkanah were doorkeepers for the ark;

24 Shebaniah, Joshaphat, Nethanel, Amasai, Zechariah, Benaiah, and Eliezer, the priests, were to blow the trumpets before the ark of God; and Obed-Edom and Jehiah, doorkeepers for the ark.

25 So David, the elders of Israel, and the captains over thousands went to bring up the ark of the covenant of the Lord from the house of Obed-Edom with joy.

26 And so it was, when God helped the Levites who bore the ark of the covenant of the Lord, that they offered seven bulls and seven rams.

27 David was clothed with a robe of fine linen, as were all the Levites who bore the ark,

the singers, and Chenaniah the music master with the singers. David also wore a linen ephod.

28 Thus all Israel brought up the ark of the covenant of the Lord with shouting and with the sound of the horn, with trumpets and with cymbals, making music with stringed instruments and harps.

29 And it happened, as the ark of the covenant of the Lord came to the City of David, that Michal, Saul's daughter, looked through a window and saw King David whirling and playing music; and she despised him in her heart.

II. Key Summary

- David told the leaders of the Levites to appoint singers: Heman, Asaph, and Ethan sounded the bronze cymbals, others played strings and harps, Chenaniah was in charge of teaching the music, and gatekeepers and trumpeters were assigned before the ark (v16-24).
 - David, the elders of Israel, and the captains over thousands brought up the ark from the house of Obed-Edom with joy; when God helped the Levites who carried the ark, they offered seven bulls and seven rams (v25-26).
 - David and the others wore robes of fine linen, and all Israel brought the ark into the City of David with shouting, horns, trumpets, and music; Michal watched through a window, saw David whirling and playing music, and despised him in her heart (v27-29).
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III. Passage Analysis

God Helped Them Lift It

The Levites, remembering the breach upon Uzza, were probably ready to tremble when they took up the ark; but God helped them, that is, he encouraged them to it, silenced their fears, and strengthened their faith. [1]

The ark wasn't that heavy — what the Levites needed wasn't muscle, but courage to face the fear left from last time. "God helped" in v26 means God was with them as they took that step, and they responded by offering thanks.

Dancing for God's Eyes

David didn't hold back anything in his own expression of worship. He didn't dance out of obligation but out of heartfelt worship. [2]

Michal cared about what a king was supposed to look like, but David wore the same linen as everyone else (v27) and danced along with them. He wasn't performing — he was truly glad the ark had come home, so Michal's contempt couldn't stop him.

IV. Reflection Question

Michal watched David dance from a window and despised him. What's the most recent thing you held back from doing because you worried someone nearby was watching and might laugh at you?

David set aside his royal robes and danced with everyone, and Michal's contempt didn't stop him, because what he cared about was that the ark had come home — God was coming to live among His people.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry, "Commentary on 1 Chronicles 15",
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_015.cfm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 15 – The Ark Is Brought to Jerusalem",
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-15/>